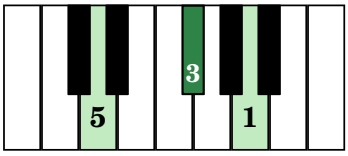
Unit 4

D Major

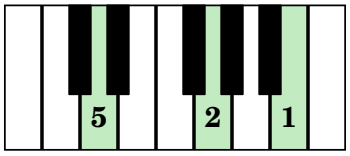
New: Two sharps (F-sharp and C-sharp); D major and its chords

D major has two sharps: F-sharp and C-sharp. You met D position in Volume 1, when only F was sharp. Now the key signature shows both sharps, so every F and every C in the piece is played on a black key.

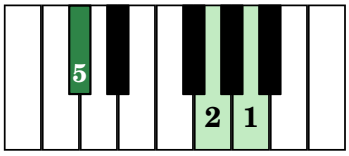
D major: left-hand chord shapes



I = D

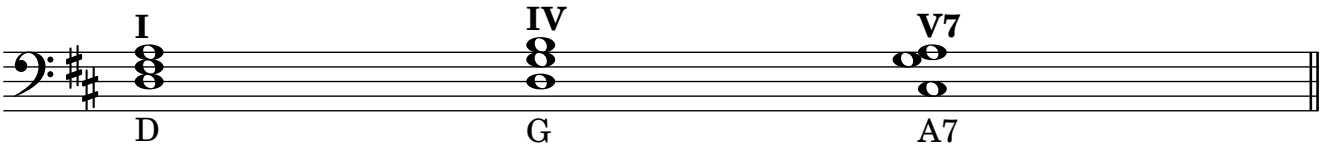


IV = G



V7 = A7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Two sharps

The key signature of D major has a sharp on the F line and in the C space. The scale is D E F-sharp G A B C-sharp D.

Where C-sharp comes from

In the right hand, C-sharp is the note just below D: stretch the thumb down to it from D position, or play it with finger 3 in A position (A B C-sharp D E).

Chord shapes in D

I is D F-sharp A (5 3 1), IV is D G B (5 2 1) and V7 is C-sharp G A (5 2 1). The V7 shape puts finger 5 on a black key.

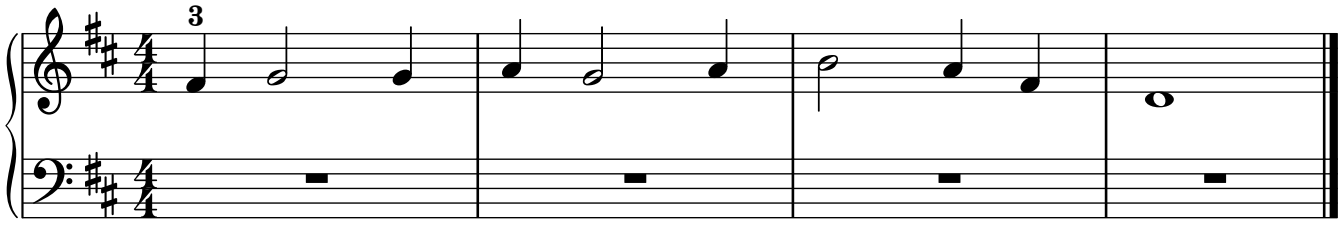
Reading tips

1. Before you play, name the two sharps aloud, and put the fingers that will play them over the black keys.
2. Read C-sharp in the left hand as 'the key below D': it is the bottom note of every V7 shape.
3. If you play a white key by mistake, keep going, and check the key signature at the next line.

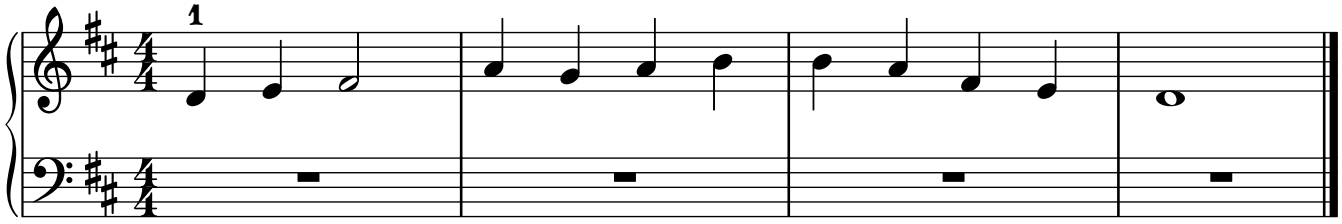
Part A: Right hand in D major ♩= 60

Right hand in D major. The thumb stretches down to C-sharp and finger 5 up to B. Metronome 60.

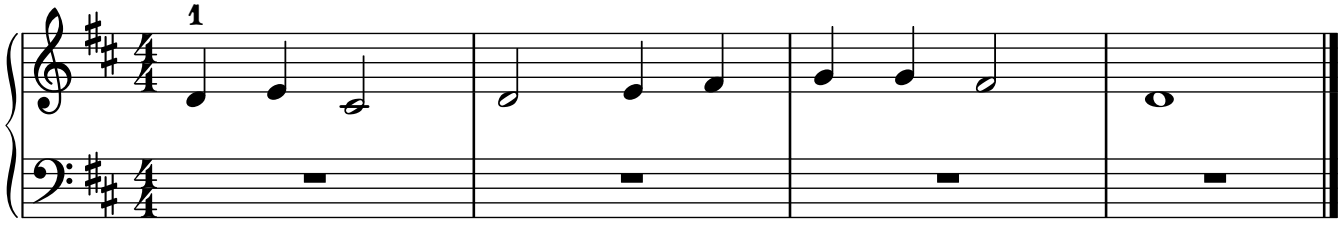
☐ **4.1**



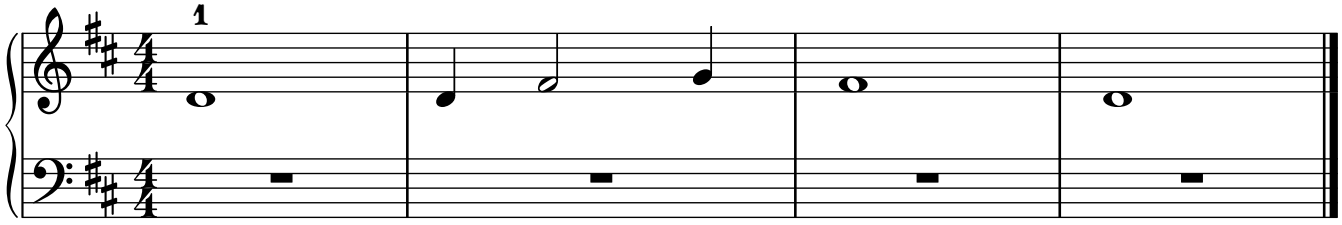
☐ **4.2**



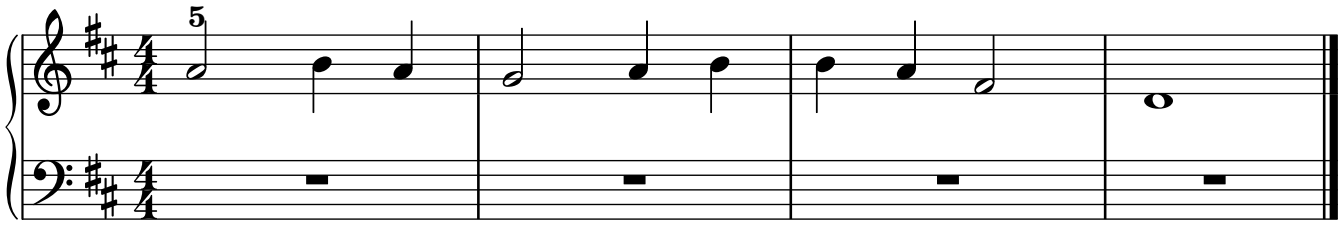
☐ **4.3**



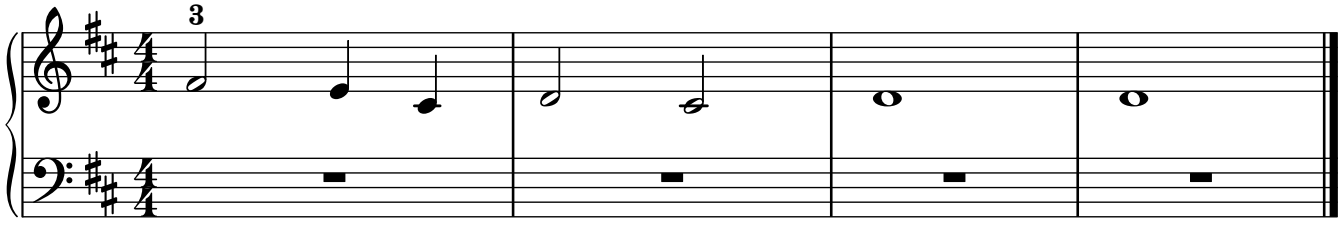
☐ **4.4**



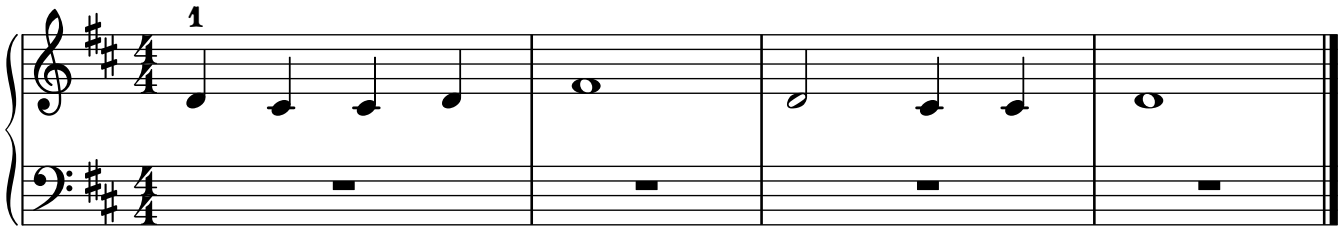
☐ **4.5**



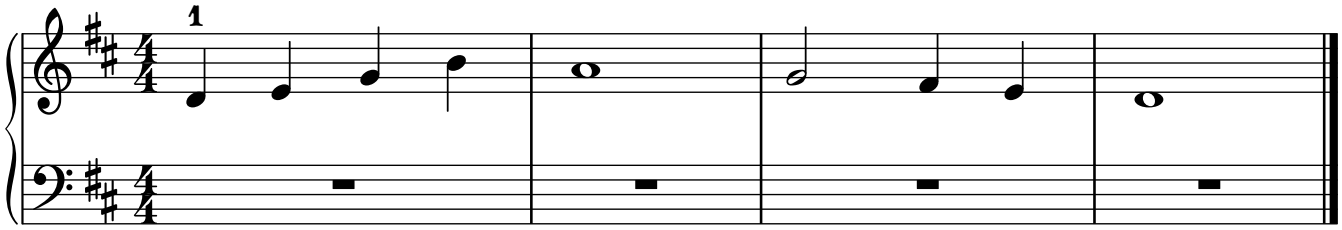
☐ **4.6**



☐ **4.7**



☐ **4.8**



Part B: D major with an Alberti bass ♩ = 60

Alberti bass in D major. The right hand moves between D position and A position.

☐ **4.9**



☐ **4.10**



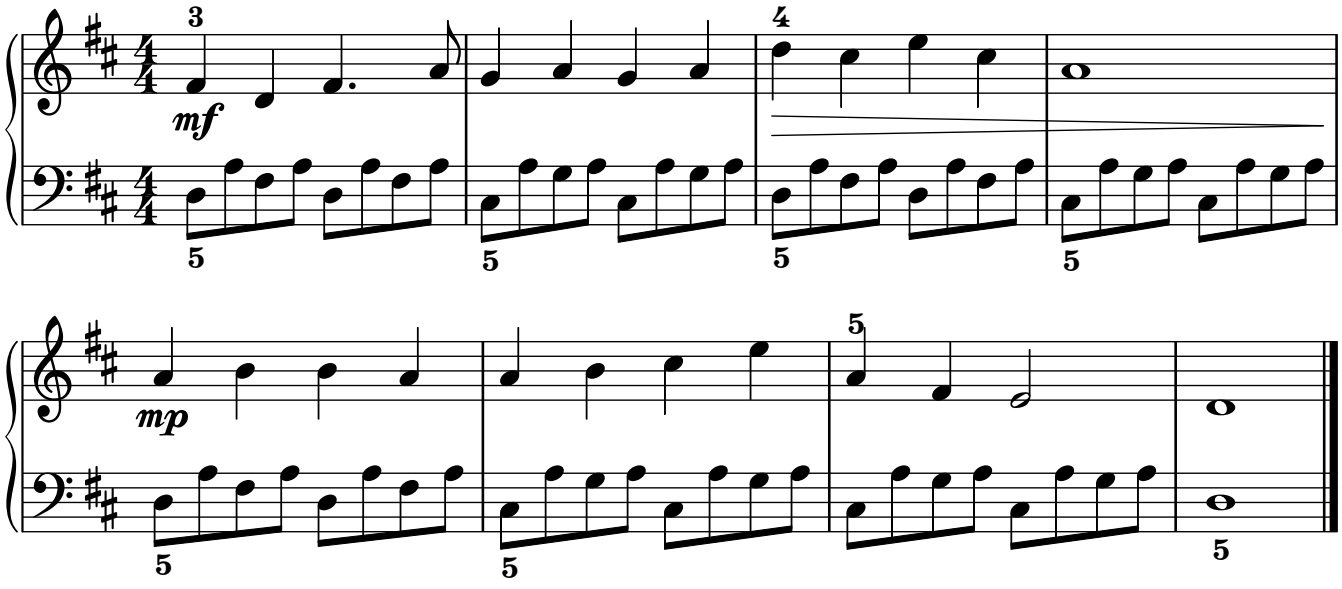
4.11



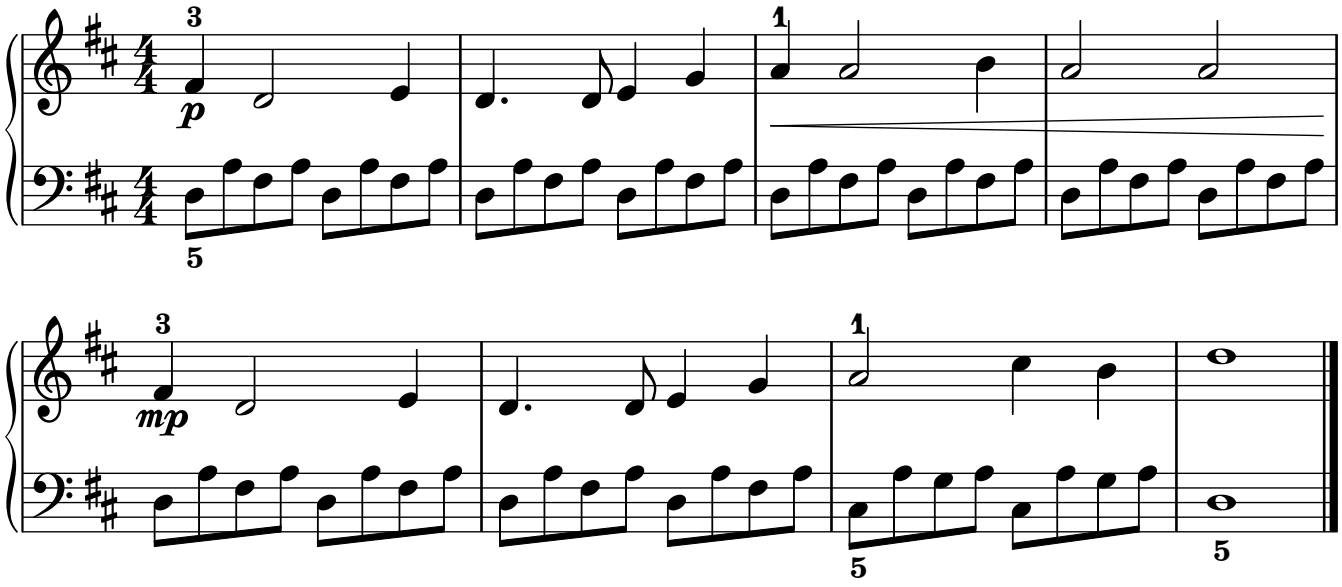
4.12



4.13



4.14



4.15



4.16



4.17



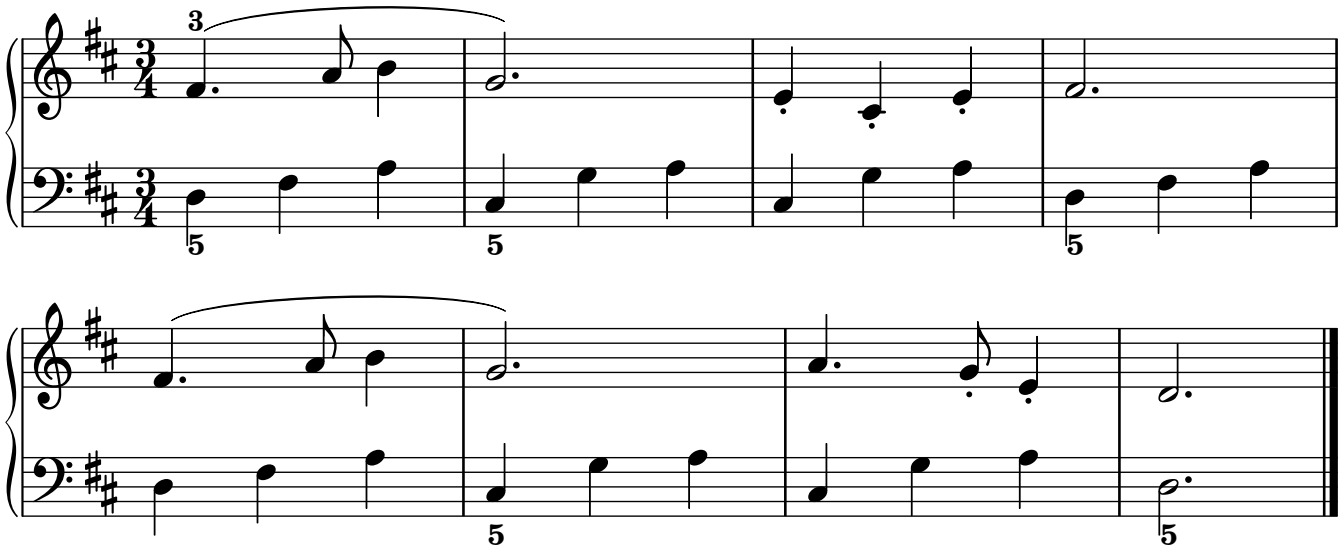
4.18



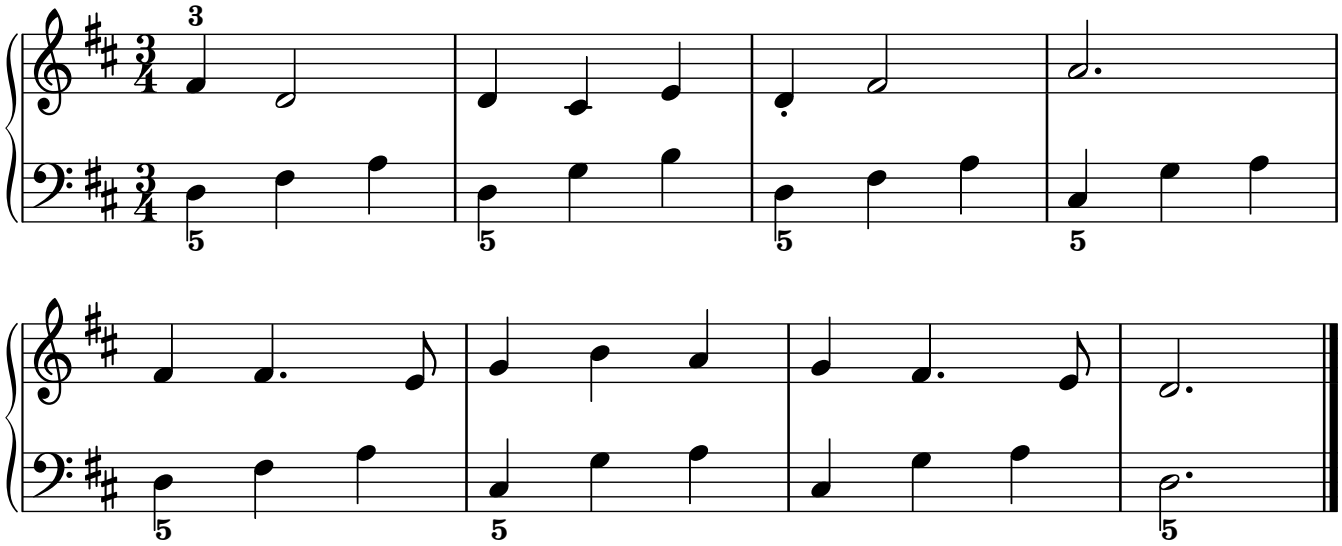
Part C: A waltz in D major ♩ = 72

A waltz in D major, with the broken-chord bass from Unit 1.

☐ **4.19**



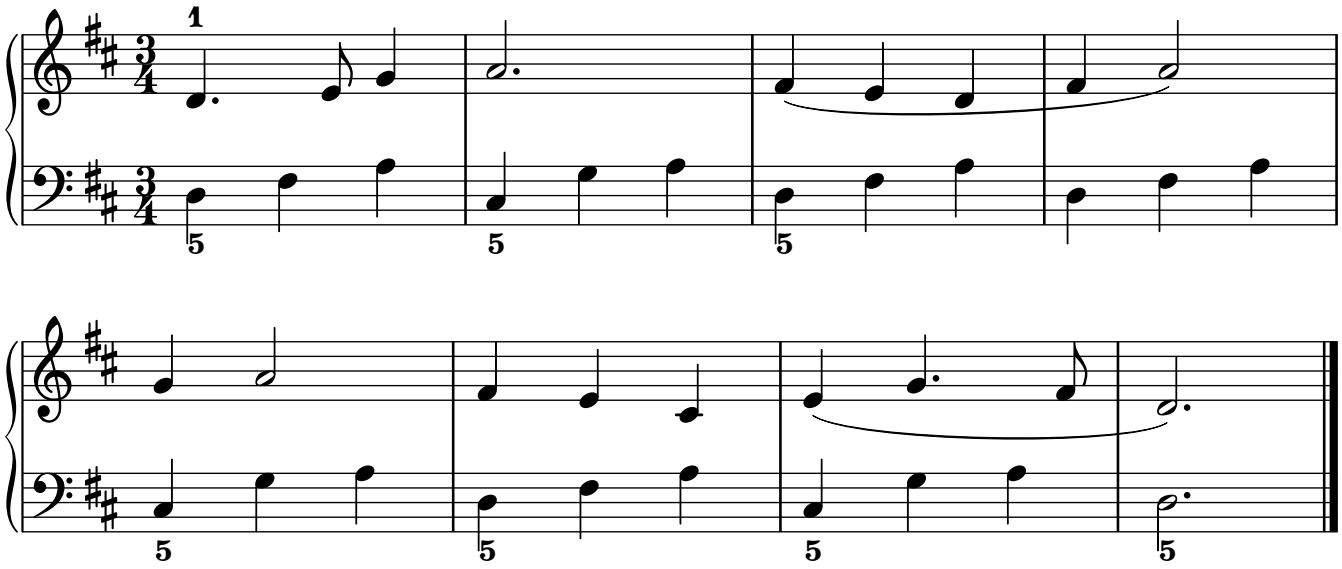
☐ **4.20**



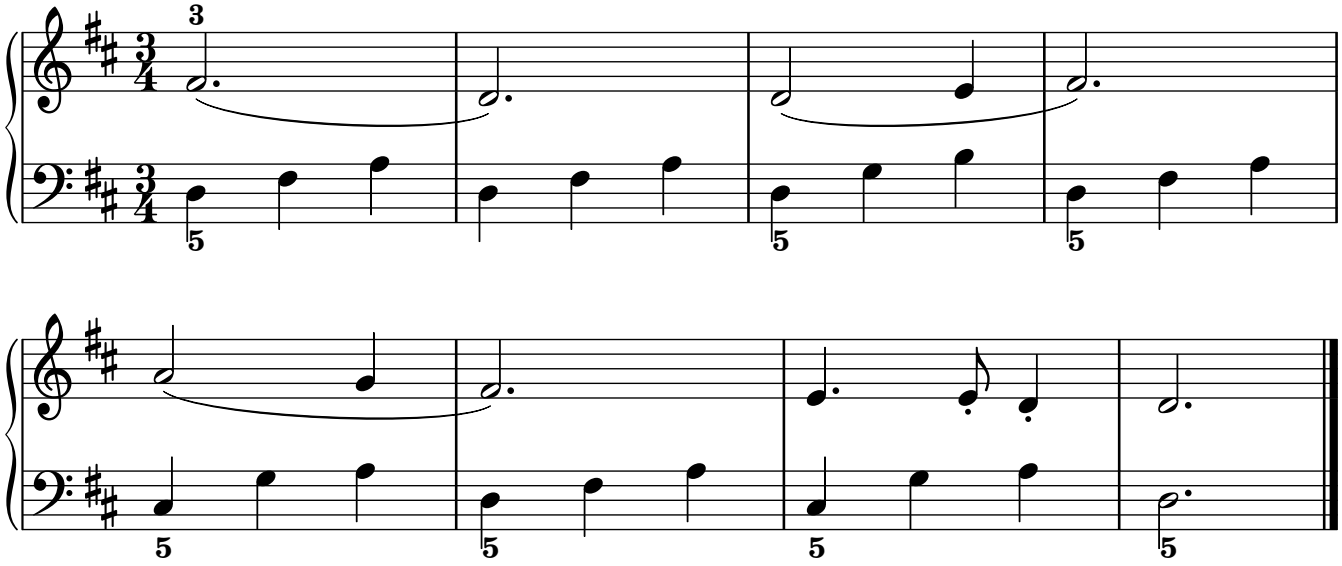
☐ **4.21**



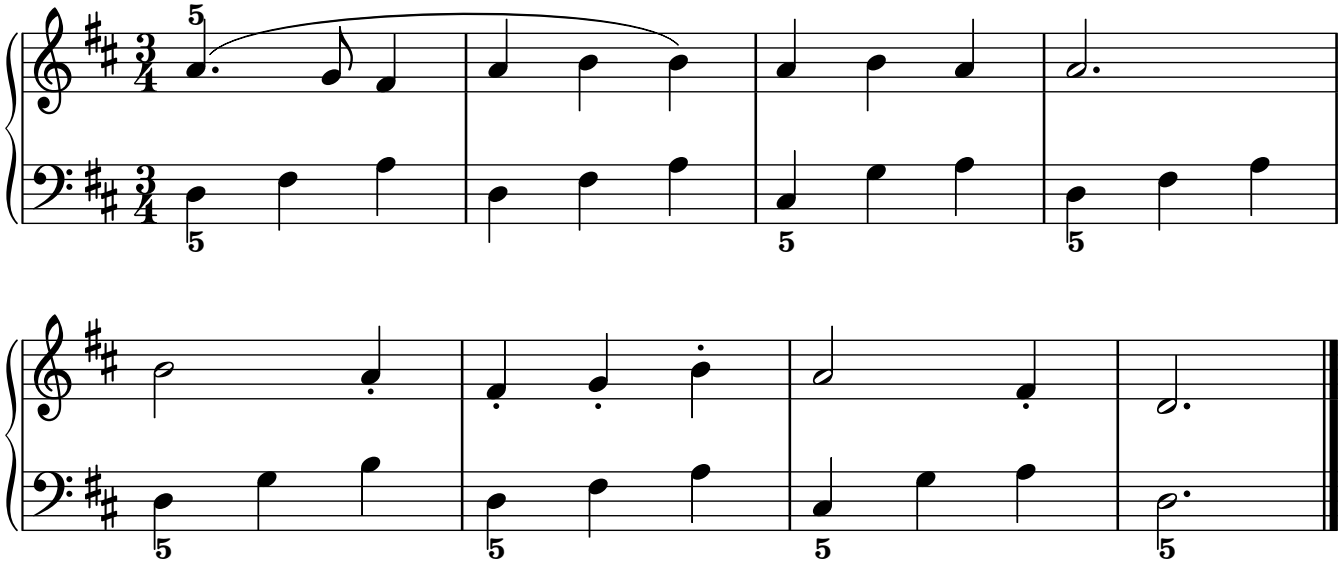
4.22



4.23



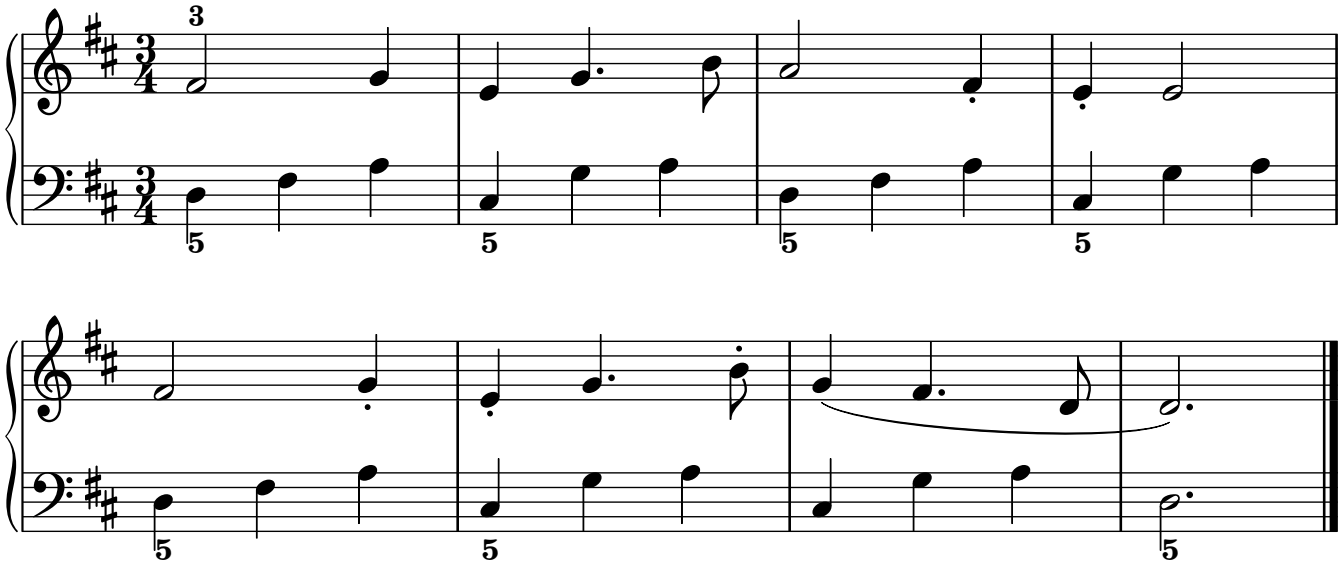
4.24



4.25



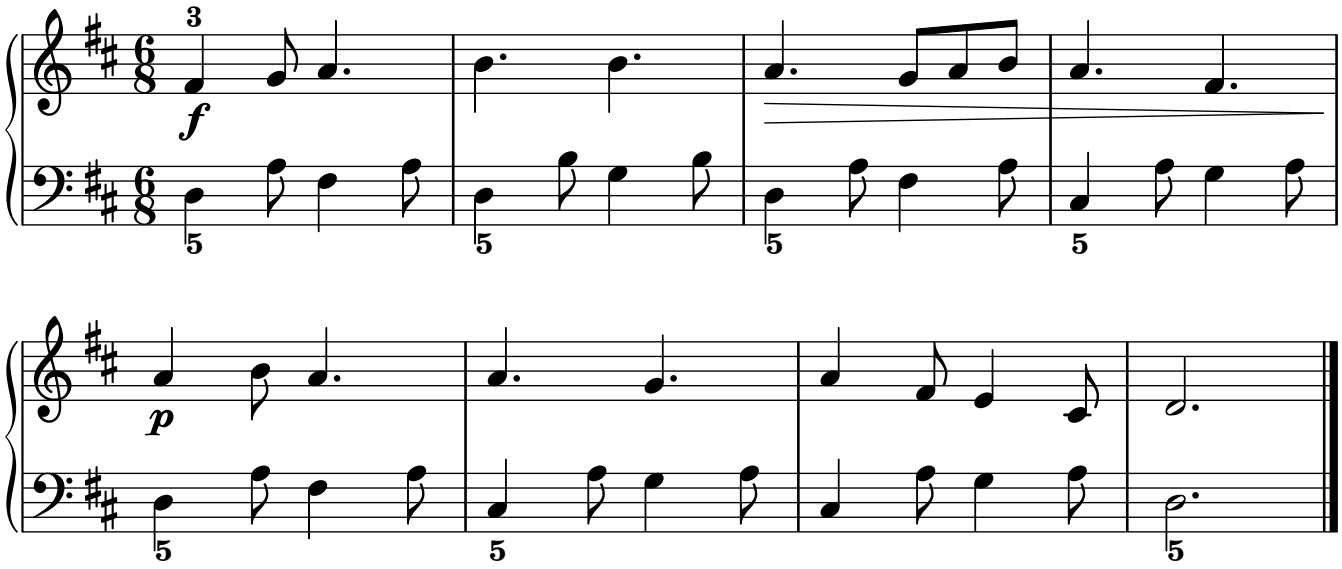
4.26



Part D: D major in 6/8 ♩. = 50

D major in 6/8, with the lilting bass from Unit 3.

☐ **4.27**



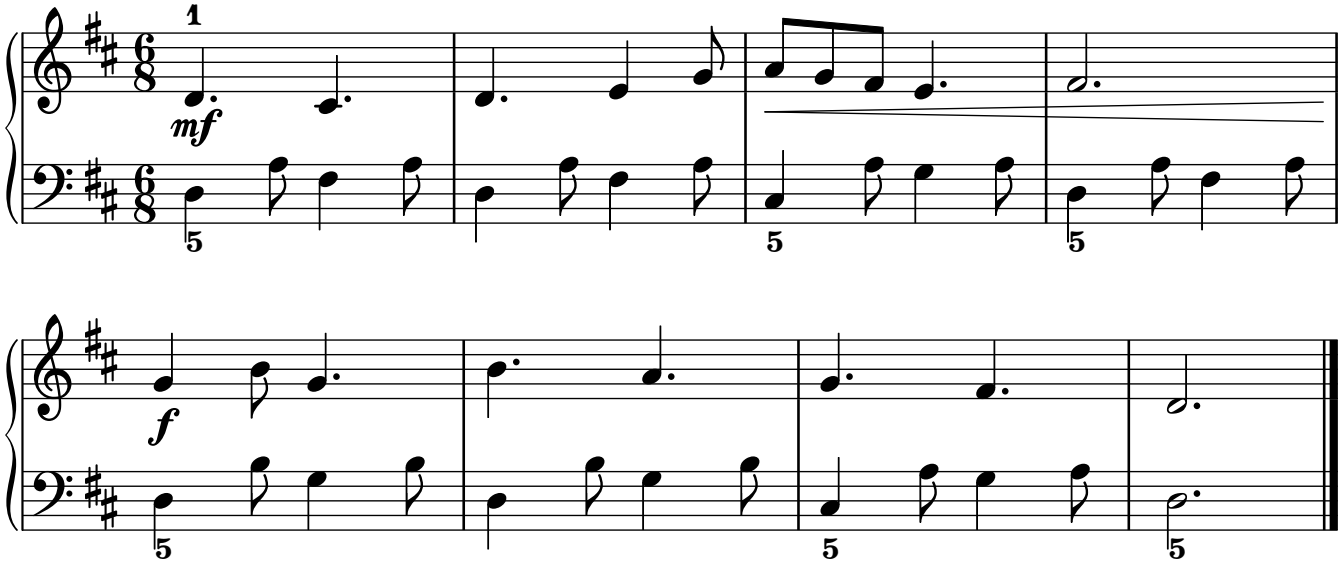
☐ **4.28**



4.29



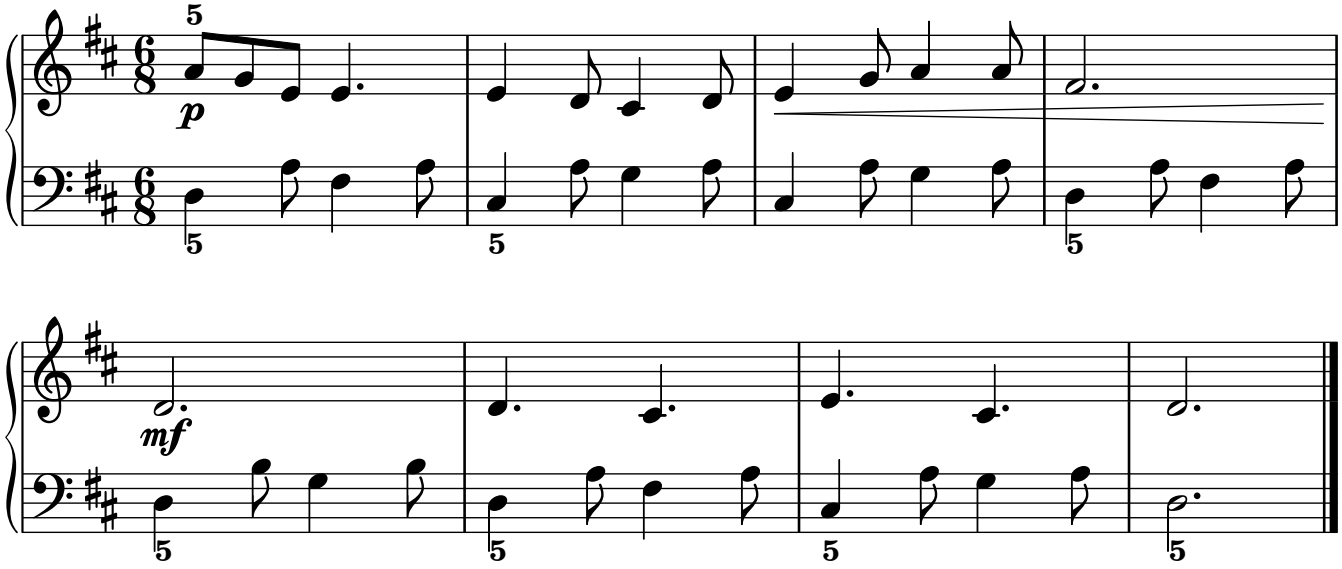
4.30



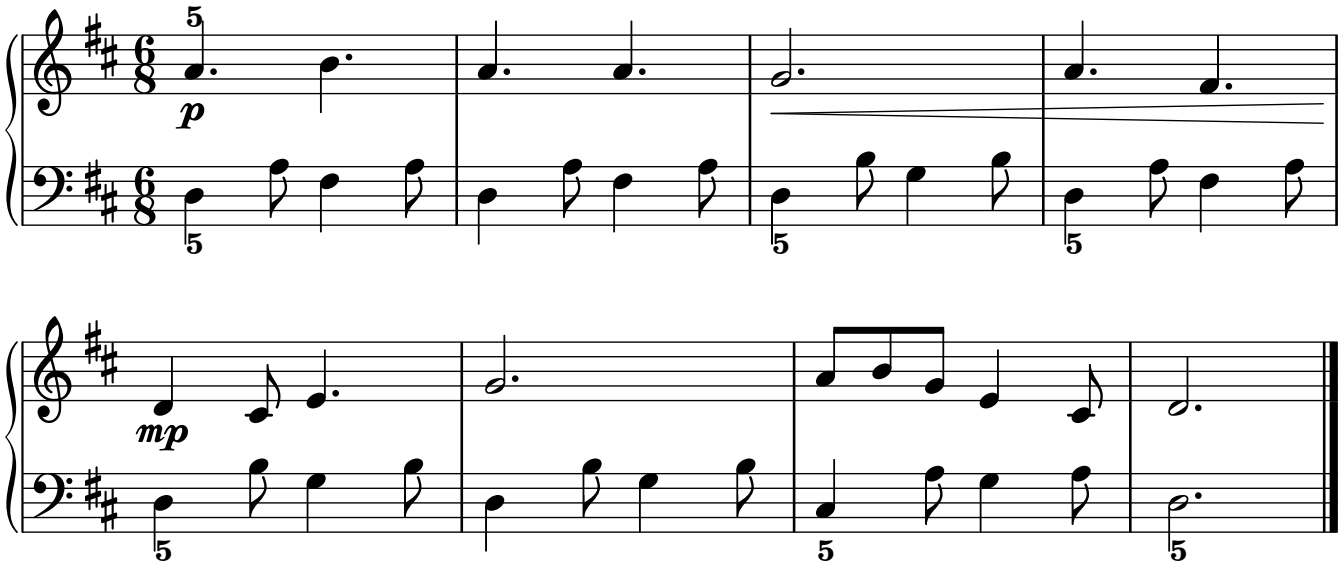
4.31



4.32



4.33



4.34



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Lightly Row ♩ = 88

Traditional German folk song ('Hänschen klein')

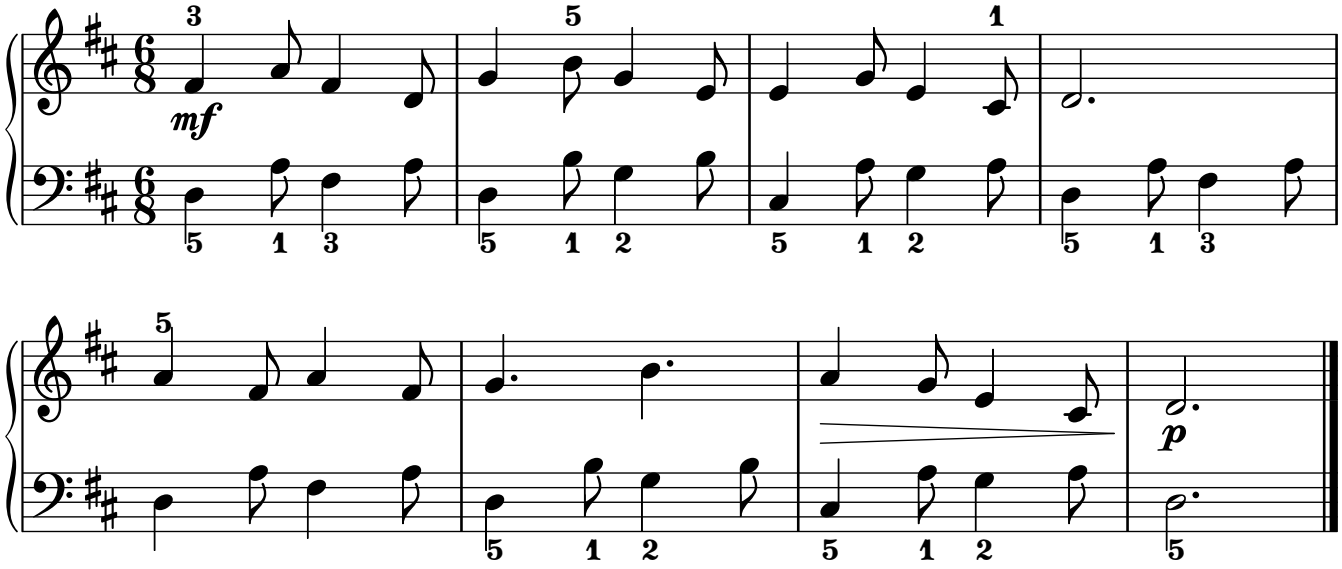
A folk song in D major. The right hand stays in D position all the way through. In bar 15 the left hand changes from I to V7 halfway through the bar.



Country Dance in D ♩. = 60

Original

A 6/8 dance with the lilting bass. In bars 3 and 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to C-sharp, which leads up to D.



Bells in D ♩ = 72

Original

The right hand starts in A position, where finger 3 plays C-sharp, and moves down to D position in bar 6. The left hand plays an Alberti bass.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

- Play five new Part B or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every F and C is sharp, in both hands, without stopping to think.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.